AR-06 Pediatric Failed Airway

CLAIBORNE COUNTY EMS | MEDICAL-DIRECTOR APPROVED | SOURCE PDF | OCTOBER 17, 2026

Scope: Use when a child cannot be oxygenated or ventilated, anatomy is unsafe for further attempts, deterioration follows an unsuccessful attempt, or there are three unsuccessful laryngoscopy attempts.

Field flow

1. Declare	Stop laryngoscopy, call for resources, bring rescue equipment, and optimize BVM immediately.
2. BVM	Neutral position, suction, age-appropriate adjuncts, correct mask seal, oxygen, PEEP, and two-person technique.
3. Rescue	If BVM ineffective/prolonged ventilation needed: authorized age/size BIAD or deliberate Paramedic rescue.
4. Confirm	Waveform EtCO2, secure device, warmth, post-airway care, immediate notification, and transport.

Provider-level actions

Level	Approved actions
EMT	Stop attempts and continue BVM as the definitive field airway when it provides effective oxygenation and ventilation.
AEMT	All EMT care plus authorized pediatric BIAD and waveform capnography. ETT and video laryngoscopy are not AEMT procedures under this protocol.
Paramedic	All prior care plus age/size BIAD or changed deliberate video-laryngoscopy rescue only when BVM is ineffective. Surgical rescue only when age-appropriate and specifically authorized.

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SAFETY, MEDICATION, AND LINKED-PATHWAY REFERENCE

Safety and escalation

- Do not wait for three attempts when BVM is ineffective, oxygenation/ventilation is deteriorating, or anatomy is unsafe.
- Judge BVM success by chest rise, SpO2 trend, mental status/perfusion, and waveform EtCO2 when available - not SpO2 alone.
- Do not use repeated blind BIAD or laryngoscopy attempts.
- If HR remains below 60/min with poor perfusion despite oxygenation/ventilation, start CPR and follow PC-02.

Linked pathways

AR-05 Pediatric Airway; AR-08 Post-Intubation / BIAD Management; PC-02 Pediatric Bradycardia / Poor Perfusion; PC-04 Pediatric Pulseless Arrest.

Source control

- This controlled direct source PDF replaces the prior source file and matches approved Claiborne EMS app content released October 17, 2026.
- Use current Claiborne standing orders, formulary, equipment authorization, and Medical Control direction whenever they govern a case-specific decision.